

Ekaterina Smirnova

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Professional Summary

Senior QA Engineer / QA Lead with 12+ years of experience defining risk-based quality strategies for complex backend, API, integration, mobile, and distributed systems. Strong background in requirements and testability analysis, test coverage strategy, exploratory testing, and identifying quality risks and failure modes before implementation. Experienced in working with Engineering and Product to define pragmatic testing approaches across different levels, balancing product risk, system complexity, and delivery goals.

Skills

Testing & Quality Strategy: Risk-Based Testing, Test Analysis, Test Planning, Test Strategy, Test Design, Test Coverage Strategy, Requirements Analysis, Testability Analysis, Integration Testing, System Testing, Exploratory Testing, Regression Testing, Release Readiness

Mobile & System Testing: Android, iOS, Mobile Testing, Physical Device Testing, End-to-End Testing, Integration Testing

Programming & Test Automation: Python, TypeScript, Java; pytest, Playwright, Appium, Selenide; maintaining, debugging and improving existing automated tests

Backend & APIs: REST APIs, Postman, Swagger/OpenAPI, SQL, PostgreSQL, Microservices, Distributed Systems, Service Dependencies, Data Flows

Technical Investigation: Linux, ELK/Kibana, Log Analysis, Production Issue Investigation, Root-Cause Analysis

Delivery & Tools: Agile, Scrum, CI/CD Workflows, Jira, Confluence, Xray, TestRail, Git, GitHub

Work History

Senior QA Engineer / QA Lead

08/2024 to present

BrainRocket – Spain | Online Entertainment Platform

- Owned and evolved risk-based quality strategy, test coverage, and release-readiness criteria across backend services, APIs, integrations, and critical product workflows.
- Defined and executed test coverage across API, integration, regression, negative, exploratory, and end-to-end scenarios for critical business workflows.
- Performed backend and API testing using Postman and Swagger/OpenAPI specifications.
- Validated data consistency, error handling, service integrations, and critical product workflows across distributed components.
- Reviewed business and technical requirements with Product and Engineering to identify quality risks, coverage gaps, edge cases, and testability issues before implementation.
- Worked with Engineering to determine appropriate test coverage across API, integration, end-to-end, and exploratory testing based on product risk, system dependencies, and change scope.
- Investigated production and pre-production issues using logs, data, and service interactions, collaborating with engineers to identify root causes and validate solutions.

QA Lead

04/2023 to 07/2024

FxPro – Cyprus | Financial Technology Platform (FinTech)

- Performed hands-on testing of native iOS and Android applications across functional, integration, API, exploratory, and acceptance scenarios.
- Defined risk-based test strategy, test coverage, regression scope, and critical user-flow scenarios for mobile applications in a regulated fintech environment.
- Worked with an existing Java-based mobile automation framework using Appium and Selenide, including reading, debugging, and modifying automated tests.
- Investigated mobile and integration issues and collaborated with Development teams during defect analysis and resolution.
- Reviewed requirements and identified testability issues, edge cases, and quality risks before implementation.
- Established QA processes and testing standards and monitored release readiness.

Arrival – Tbilisi, Georgia | International electric vehicle manufacturer headquartered in London

- Led a QA team of 8 engineers, coordinating testing activities and resourcing, mentoring team members, defining quality priorities, and ensuring sufficient test coverage across complex cross-functional projects.
- Conducted end-to-end testing of embedded vehicle software using real hardware and test rigs.
- Investigated and reproduced complex integration issues across distributed software and hardware components.
- Reviewed and validated 26+ system and technical requirements, including component interactions and communication workflows.
- Designed and executed test scenarios for 35+ vehicle features across embedded and distributed systems.
- Supported 18 releases and maintained technical test documentation and requirements traceability in Polarion.
- Collaborated closely with software engineers, system engineers, and product stakeholders throughout defect investigation and release preparation.
- Used ADB, CANalyzer, and other diagnostic tools to troubleshoot vehicle HMI systems and analyse communication between software and hardware components.

Senior QA Specialist
05/2019 to 12/2020

OKKO – Saint Petersburg, Russia | Online video streaming platform

- Performed exploratory, REST API, integration, and backend testing for approximately 10 Java- and Python-based microservices.
- Investigated application architecture, service dependencies, and data flows to identify and reproduce complex issues.
- Validated application data across PostgreSQL, Cassandra, Redis, and DynamoDB, including SQL-based checks for relational data.
- Maintained, debugged, and improved existing API automated tests in Python using pytest.
- Investigated production and pre-production issues using Linux command-line tools, logs, and the Elastic Stack.
- Collaborated closely with developers to analyse root causes and verify fixes across distributed services.
- Conducted knowledge-sharing and training sessions for QA colleagues on microservice architecture, testing approaches, and investigation of complex integration issues.

QA Specialist / Scrum Master
03/2018 to 05/2019

IQ Option – Saint Petersburg, Russia | Online trading platform for binary options

- Performed API testing for a verification service (PHP), ensuring reliability of critical user validation flows.
- Investigated issues using bash and log analysis, identifying root causes and improving defect resolution across services.
- Established and scaled quality practices for the verification service, working with engineers to identify coverage gaps and align exploratory, manual, and automated testing based on risk.

QA Specialist
05/2017 to 03/2018

Yandex – Saint Petersburg, Russia | Search engine and intelligent services based on machine learning

- Performed exploratory, functional, and end-to-end testing of a B2B web and mobile SaaS platform.
- Investigated and reproduced user-reported issues using browser DevTools and technical evidence.
- Reviewed feature requirements and improved their testability before implementation.
- Established QA processes and test documentation, supervised three outsourced QA engineers, coordinated their testing activities, and supported releases through production.

Education

Master of Science - Cyber Security

06/2015

ITMO University | Saint Petersburg, Russia

Bachelor of Science - Information Technology

06/2012

Saint Petersburg Polytechnic University | Saint Petersburg, Russia

Languages

Russian: Native language

English: C1

Spanish: A2